

Teaching Evaluations: A Summary

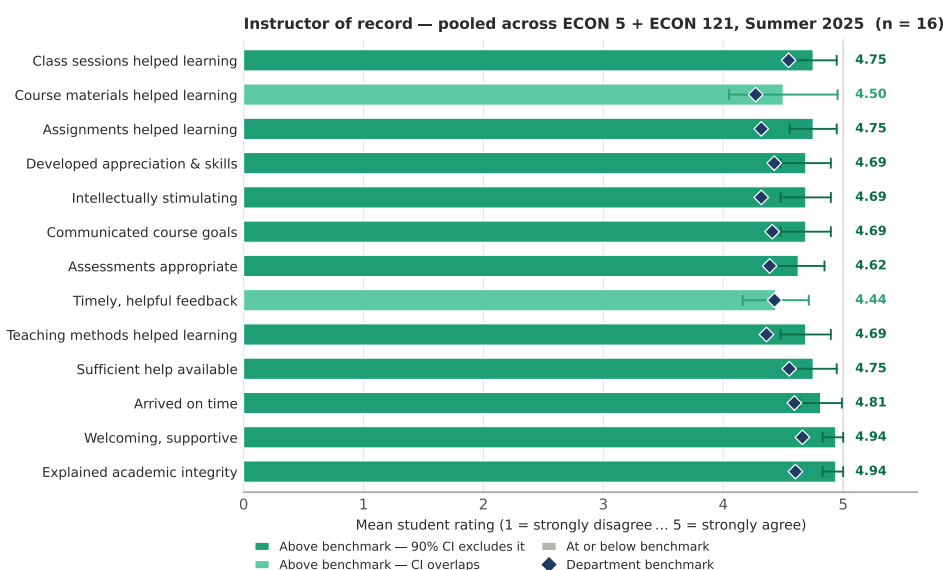
Idaliya Grigoryeva • University of California, San Diego

Student ratings, 2022–2026 • instructor of record and teaching / instructional assistant

This note summarizes roughly **330 student evaluations** collected at UC San Diego between 2022 and 2026: two courses as **instructor of record** (ECON 5 and ECON 121, three sections, $n = 32$) and sixteen discussion and lab sections as a **teaching / instructional assistant** ($n \approx 296$), spanning ECON 5, ECON 100A, ECON 121, ECON 171, ECON 190, and GPEC 443. All ratings are on the standard five-point scale (5 = strongly agree). Bars show the mean, with a 90% confidence interval where per-response data are available; where a departmental comparison exists it is drawn as a navy diamond, and the bar is colored by whether the rating exceeds that benchmark (see the note at the end).

Instructor of record

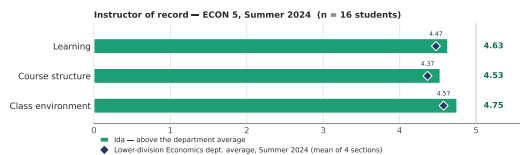
As instructor of record, Ida's ratings exceed the departmental benchmark on **every item**, and do so by a statistically meaningful margin (the 90% confidence interval clears the benchmark) on **11 of 13 items** when the two most recent courses are pooled (Figure 1). The benchmark is the mean across all Economics Summer-Session-I courses at the same level.



Bars = pooled mean with 90% t-CI (whisker capped at the 5.0 ceiling); the CI and the printed value share each bar's colour. Diamond = enrollment-weighted department benchmark. All 13 items exceed it; 11 significantly.

Figure 1. Instructor of record, pooled across ECON 5 and ECON 121 (Summer 2025, $n = 16$). Green where the 90% CI excludes the departmental benchmark, light green where it overlaps; no item is at or below benchmark.

Her earlier course as instructor of record, ECON 5 in Summer 2024 (Figure 2), shows the same pattern. The 2024 SET report itself published no departmental comparison, so the benchmark here is reconstructed from the department's own SET records: the average of every lower-division Economics Summer-Session-I section that term. At the level those records report, the three SET dimensions, Ida sits above the department on all three.

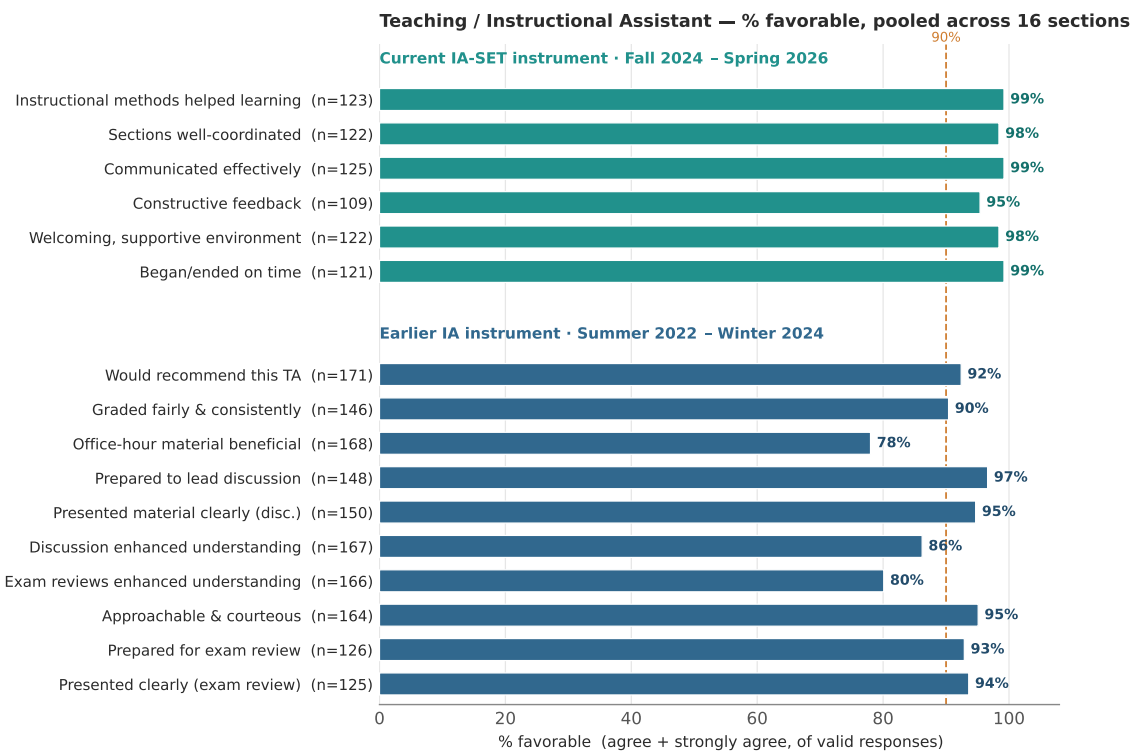


Scale: 1 = strongly disagree ... 5 = strongly agree. Bars = Ida's three SET dimension averages (each a composite of the related survey items), from the UCSD SET system. Diamond = the Summer-2024 lower-division Economics Summer-Session-I department average (mean of all 4 such sections), computed from the department's own SET records. Ida is above the department on all three dimensions.

Figure 2. Instructor of record, ECON 5 (Summer 2024, $n = 16$). Bars are Ida's three SET dimension averages; the navy diamond is the Summer-2024 lower-division Economics department average (the mean of the four lower-division sections that term), reconstructed from the department's SET records because the 2024 report published no comparison.

Teaching and instructional assistant

Across sixteen TA and IA sections, student endorsement is high and stable. On the current instructional-assistant instrument (Fall 2024 onward), **95–99% of students** respond favorably on every item, including communication, a welcoming environment, and constructive feedback; on the earlier instrument, favorability ranges from 78% to 97%, with the lowest values on whether exam-review and office-hour sessions deepened understanding (Figure 3). The mean ratings tell the same story (Figure 4), with tight intervals reflecting the large pooled samples (n up to 171 per item).



Teal = the current IA-SET instrument; blue = the earlier instrument (its items differ, so the two are pooled separately). n = pooled valid responses per item.

Figure 3. Share of students responding favorably (agree or strongly agree), pooled across all TA/IA sections. Teal = the current IA-SET instrument; blue = the earlier instrument, whose items differ.

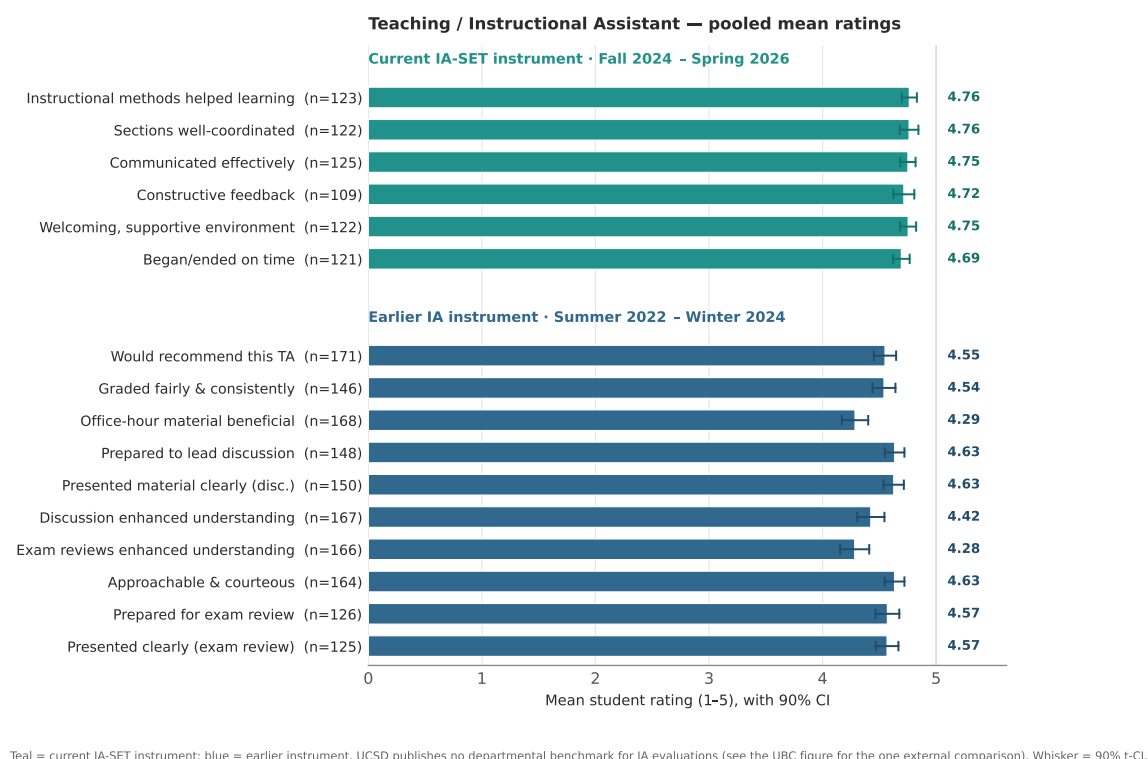
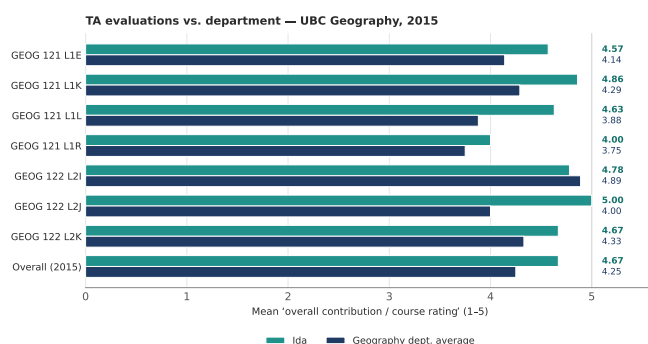


Figure 4. Pooled mean ratings with 90% confidence intervals, by instrument.

UC San Diego does not publish a departmental benchmark for instructional-assistant evaluations, so the TA figures above stand on their own. The one TA evaluation in the record that *does* carry a departmental comparison is from an earlier role at the University of British Columbia (Figure 5): across seven Geography sections in 2015, Ida’s “overall contribution / course rating” averaged **4.67** against the department’s **4.25**, above the department in six of the seven sections.



The only TA evaluation in the record that carries a departmental comparison. Across seven sections her rating averaged 4.67 vs. the department’s 4.25, above the department in six of seven sections. (Different institution, instrument, and era from the UCSD figures.)

Figure 5. TA ratings vs. the Geography department average, UBC 2015. A different institution, instrument, and era, included as the only available TA-versus-department comparison.

In students’ words

The open-ended comments from 2025–2026 were tagged by theme: nearly half mention how **helpful and supportive** she is, and the next most common themes are clear explanations, encouragement that builds confidence, and patience and kindness (Figure 6). The most frequent individual words echo this (Figure 3).

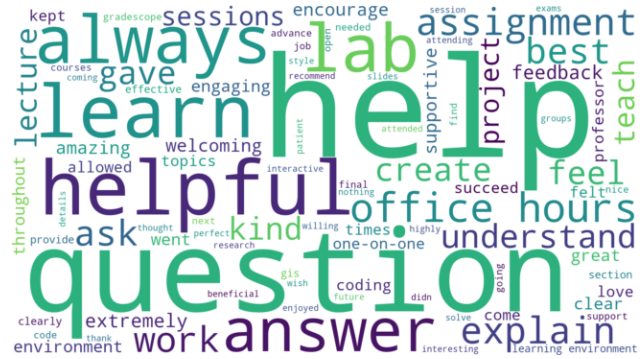
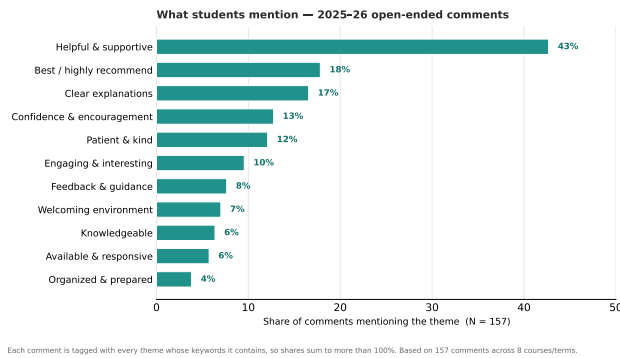


Figure 6. Left: share of 157 open-ended comments (2025–26) mentioning each theme; a comment can match several. Right: the most frequent words after merging inflections (help/helped) and folding phrases (“office hours”), with distinctive adjectives such as “helpful” kept separate.

A few representative comments:

Ida was wonderful throughout the summer session; she helped answer every question I had and made class interesting. (ECON 5, instructor of record, Summer 2025)

Very interesting and engaging; [she] kept me interested in a subject I was not previously interested in. (ECON 121, instructor of record, Summer 2025)

When I first met her, I thought she was already a professor, that's how professional and engaging she was. She is an extremely effective teacher. (GPEC 443 (GIS & Spatial Data Analysis), TA, Fall 2025)

I came into this class very nervous, and I doubted my ability to succeed. Ida was one of the first people to make me feel like I can actually do GIS. (GPEC 443, TA, Fall 2025)

Talking through my ideas was extremely helpful in refining my research question; you've really pushed me to think further each meeting. (ECON 190 (Intro to Research in Economics), TA, Winter 2025)

Love her discussion section: very well organized, effective, and engaging. She's also very helpful! (ECON 5, TA, Spring 2026)

Notes. *Sources:* UC San Diego official Student Evaluation of Teaching (SET) and Instructional-Assistant evaluation reports and their per-response data exports, 2022–2026, plus the UBC Geography TA report (2015). *Statistics:* bars are means on the 1–5 scale; whiskers are 90% *t*-confidence intervals ($df = n - 1$), with the upper whisker capped at the scale ceiling of 5.0. “Favorable” counts *agree* and *strongly agree* among valid (non–“not applicable”) responses. *Color rule (instructor figures):* green = mean above benchmark and the 90% CI lower bound also above it; light green = mean above benchmark but the CI overlaps it; gray = at or below benchmark; the CI whisker and the printed value share each bar’s color. *Benchmarks:* the two Summer-2025 instructor reports publish a per-item departmental comparison; for ECON 5 (Summer 2024), whose report published none, the comparison is the lower-division Economics Summer-Session-I department average that term, reconstructed from the department’s own SET records (every Economics section, extracted from the campus SET system) and shown at the three SET-dimension composites, the finest level those records report. No UCSD TA/IA report publishes a comparison. *Comments:* themes are keyword-tagged on 157 de-duplicated 2025–26 comments; the figures and all underlying data are reproducible from [teaching_evals/src/](#).